

Weekly Start/Sit Decisions

How to apply the draft board's analytical framework to weekly lineup decisions once the season is underway.

1. Start with projected points - but matchup-adjusted, not season-long

A static "he's my WR2 for the season" ranking isn't enough - the specific matchup matters:

- Points allowed to that position by the specific defense he's facing (not just "is this a good defense," but "is this defense specifically bad against WRs/RBs/TEs" - those can be very different things)
- Recent opportunity trend - a player whose target/touch share is rising over the last 2-3 weeks should be trusted more than his season-long average suggests, and vice versa for a declining role

2. Game script - who's likely to be winning or losing

One of the biggest weekly swing factors, driven by Vegas lines rather than box scores:

- Implied team total (derived from the spread and over/under) shows how many points a team is expected to score - a team implied for 27+ points is a good environment for everyone on that offense.
- Large favorites tend to run more in the second half (protecting a lead), which boosts real workhorse RBs.
- Large underdogs tend to pass more, especially garbage-time volume, which can boost WR/TE target volume even in a game that looks bad overall - though this is less predictable than a positive script.

3. Floor vs. ceiling - the same framework from the draft board

- Close matchup, need a reliable win: start the higher-floor player, even if his ceiling is lower.
- Big underdog in your own matchup, need a spike to have a chance: start the higher-ceiling player, even if he's less consistent.
- Comfortably ahead: floor again - no reason to take unnecessary risk.

4. Situational red flags

- Injury designations (questionable/doubtful) - a real risk of a zero, not just reduced production.
 - Weather - meaningful for outdoor passing games and kickers specifically, less so for most positions.
 - Short rest (Thursday games) - can slightly suppress workload and big plays.
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A Natural Next Build

This is a strong candidate for a lightweight companion to the draft board once the season actually starts - a weekly tool pulling current-week matchup data, Vegas lines, and injury news for a given roster, then applying the same floor/ceiling logic already built and validated. Not buildable yet, since it depends on real in-season data (live lines, current injury reports, actual matchups) that doesn't exist before the season begins.